

Task 17 — Hands-on Investigation

LetsDefend / TryHackMe Blue-Team Practical Report

Student: Mudasir Zia

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Focus: SOC monitoring, Windows investigation, PowerShell analysis

1. Objective

Perform practical blue-team/SOC investigation work using LetsDefend or CyberDefenders, investigate security evidence, understand the True Positive/False Positive decision process, and document the practical work. The task also required at least one compulsory free TryHackMe blue-team room.

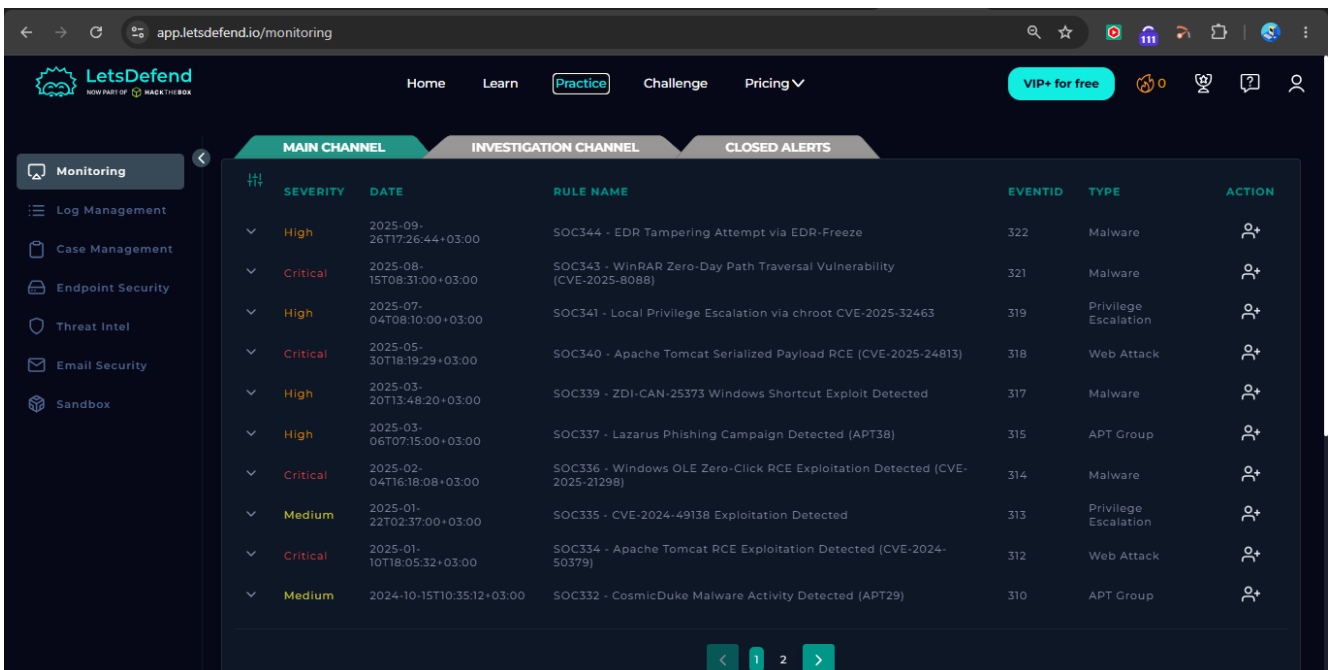
2. Verified Practical Work

Activity	Evidence / result
LetsDefend Monitoring	Monitoring interface accessed; alert queue and alert metadata visible.
TryHackMe Investigating Windows	Room shows 100% completion.
LetsDefend PowerShell Script	Challenge completed; completion proof captured.

3. LetsDefend Monitoring Evidence

The captured Monitoring screenshot shows the LetsDefend SOC interface with Main Channel, Investigation Channel, Closed Alerts, severity, dates, rule names, Event IDs, alert types, and investigation controls. The visible queue contains several security alert records.

Important: This screenshot proves monitoring access and visible alerts, but it does not show the detailed investigation page or a final alert verdict.

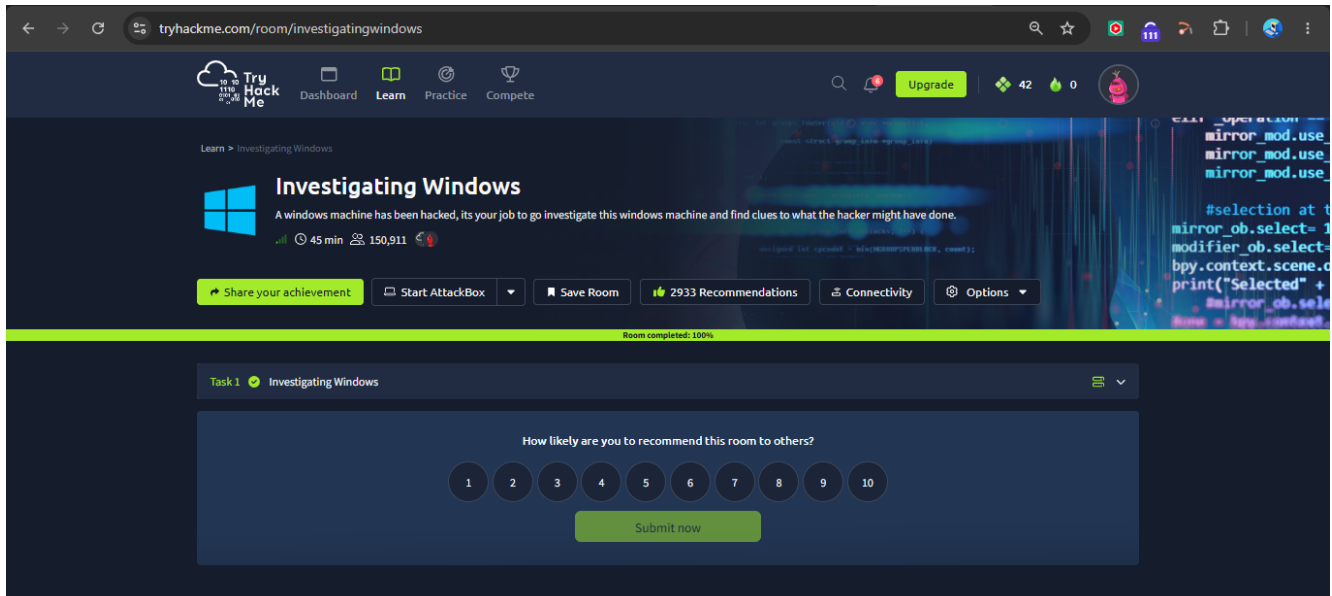


The screenshot displays the LetsDefend Monitoring interface. The top navigation bar includes links for Home, Learn, Practice, Challenge, and Pricing. A sidebar on the left lists various security modules: Monitoring, Log Management, Case Management, Endpoint Security, Threat Intel, Email Security, and Sandbox. The main content area is titled 'MAIN CHANNEL' and shows a table of alerts. The table has columns for SEVERITY, DATE, RULE NAME, EVENTID, TYPE, and ACTION. The alerts are listed in descending order of date, with the most recent at the top. The table shows 10 alerts, with the first 9 visible in the screenshot. The alerts are categorized by severity (High, Critical, Medium) and type (Malware, Privilege Escalation, Web Attack, APT Group).

SEVERITY	DATE	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE	ACTION
High	2025-09-26T17:26:44+03:00	SOC344 - EDR Tampering Attempt via EDR-Freeze	322	Malware	
Critical	2025-08-15T08:31:00+03:00	SOC343 - WinRAR Zero-Day Path Traversal Vulnerability (CVE-2025-8088)	321	Malware	
High	2025-07-04T08:10:00+03:00	SOC341 - Local Privilege Escalation via chroot CVE-2025-32463	319	Privilege Escalation	
Critical	2025-05-30T18:19:29+03:00	SOC340 - Apache Tomcat Serialized Payload RCE (CVE-2025-24813)	318	Web Attack	
High	2025-03-20T13:48:20+03:00	SOC339 - ZDI-CAN-25373 Windows Shortcut Exploit Detected	317	Malware	
High	2025-03-06T07:15:00+03:00	SOC337 - Lazarus Phishing Campaign Detected (APT38)	315	APT Group	
Critical	2025-02-04T16:18:08+03:00	SOC336 - Windows OLE Zero-Click RCE Exploitation Detected (CVE-2025-21298)	314	Malware	
Medium	2025-01-22T02:37:00+03:00	SOC335 - CVE-2024-49138 Exploitation Detected	313	Privilege Escalation	
Critical	2025-01-10T18:05:32+03:00	SOC334 - Apache Tomcat RCE Exploitation Detected (CVE-2024-50379)	312	Web Attack	
Medium	2024-10-15T10:35:12+03:00	SOC332 - CosmicDuke Malware Activity Detected (APT29)	310	APT Group	

4. TryHackMe — Investigating Windows

The compulsory Investigating Windows room was completed. The supplied evidence shows the room at 100% completion and Task 1 marked complete. The scenario focuses on investigating a compromised Windows machine and identifying attacker activity.



5. LetsDefend — PowerShell Script Challenge

An additional LetsDefend PowerShell Script challenge was completed. The challenge describes a Base64-encoded PowerShell script and asks the analyst to dissect it and understand its potential risk. The supplied screenshot also shows CyberChef as the required tool.

The screenshot shows the LetsDefend website interface for the PowerShell Script challenge. The page is divided into three main sections: PowerShell Script, Lab Environment, and Scoreboard.

PowerShell Script

You've come across a puzzling Base64 script, seemingly laced with malicious intent. Your mission, should you choose to accept it, is to dissect and analyze this script, unveiling its true nature and potential risks. Dive into the code and reveal its secrets to safeguard our digital realm. Good luck on this daring quest!

Tool Needed: Cyberchef
File Location: C:\Users\LetsDefend\Desktop\ChallengeFile\script.ps1

This challenge prepared by **ZaadoOfc**
Credit: csnp.org

Writeups:

- LetsDefend — PowerShell Script Challenge Walkthrough
- PowerShell Script — A LetsDefend Challenge

Lab Environment

Loading - 3%

Scoreboard

1	procognito
2	bakhtiyar_ismayilov98
3	nihat_alakbarli441
4	W4tson
5	0x55AA
6	jo
7	raqsana
8	akhilx
9	atalalissa

<https://stumblesec.medium.com/letsdefend-powershell-script-challenge-walkthrough-8cc8dd174a0a>

Completion proof:

The screenshot shows the LetsDefend website interface displaying the completion proof for the PowerShell Script challenge. The page features a large circular badge with a blue PowerShell script icon.

mudasir zia
has completed the
"PowerShell Script"
challenge

Badge Name:
PowerShell Script

Completed on:
Sep, 24, 2026, 07:09 AM

6. SOC Investigation Methodology

1. Validate the alert: identify the detection rule, severity, type, host, and user.
2. Collect evidence: review SIEM/Windows logs and extract IPs, usernames, processes, files, domains, and hashes.
3. Build a timeline: correlate events before and after the detection.
4. Investigate IOCs: check relevant indicators against trusted threat-intelligence sources.
5. Determine impact: identify affected accounts/endpoints and evidence of compromise.
6. Make a verdict: True Positive, False Positive, or escalate when evidence is insufficient.
7. Document and close/escalate: record evidence, reasoning, and required response actions.

7. Evidence-Based Findings

Item	Verified status
LetsDefend Monitoring access	Verified by screenshot
Visible SOC alert records	Verified by screenshot
Investigating Windows completion	Verified — 100% shown
PowerShell Script challenge	Verified — completed
Individual alert investigation page	Not present in supplied evidence
Specific IOCs and timeline	Not present in supplied evidence
Final TP/FP verdict	Not present in supplied evidence

8. Verdict / Case Disposition

The supplied evidence does not contain a specific LetsDefend alert investigation page or final True Positive/False Positive decision. Therefore this report does not fabricate a verdict, IOC list, or timeline. In a real SOC workflow, insufficient evidence should lead to continued investigation or escalation rather than an unsupported closure.

9. Skills Demonstrated

- SOC monitoring and alert metadata review
- Windows investigation workflow
- PowerShell security analysis
- Base64 analysis concepts
- Evidence collection and documentation
- True Positive / False Positive decision criteria
- SOC escalation and case-handling methodology

10. Conclusion

The practical package demonstrates hands-on use of LetsDefend and TryHackMe, completion of the compulsory Investigating Windows room, and completion of an additional LetsDefend PowerShell challenge. The report deliberately separates verified evidence from missing evidence so that no unsupported investigation result is presented as fact.